Steam train

Steam trains have engines that burn fuel in their firebox. The heat boils water to produce steam, which is fed into cylinders where it expands to drive the pistons. The movement of the pistons turns the wheels with the help of a rod and a crank, moving the train. This American locomotive from 1863, ***Thatcher Perkins***, weighs 45 tons and could haul several wagons or carriages at 50 mph (80 km/h).

Tender ❯ On many trains, this stored both water and fuel, often in the form of coal or, on this train, wood, to power the engine.

Wheel brakes ❯ To slow down the train, the driver pulls a lever, which presses brake shoes directly onto the driving wheels.